

1. Summarize the main findings of the Secret Service. Who was involved and what was discovered?
 - a. The U.S. Secret Service dismantled a network of electronic devices throughout the New York tristate area that were used to target high-ranking officials as well as almost carry out various telecommunication attacks. Nation-state actors were found to be involved.. This all happened while the U.N. was in session.
2. Where were the devices found, and why was their location significant relative to the United Nations meeting?
 - a. The devices were found in abandoned apartment buildings at multiple sites within 35 miles of the United Nations headquarters in Manhattan. The location was highly significant because the UN General Assembly was underway with nearly 150 world leaders present.
3. What potential telecommunications attacks could this network have launched?
 - a. The attack could have disabled cell phone towers and made it so that emergency services such as 911 would not be available at a critical time.
4. What triggered the investigation? How was the network uncovered?
 - a. There was a broader investigation that led to this discovery. The Secret Service was already investigating telecommunication attacks targeting senior ranking U.S. officials.
5. What is known (or unknown) about who was behind the network?
 - a. Officials believe nation-state actors were involved, with one law enforcement source suggesting foreign government connection, and evidence of communications between nation-state actors and organized crime groups, cartels, and terrorist organizations. However, no arrests have been made yet, the specific government or criminal groups have not been officially disclosed, and it remains unknown whether this was specifically intended for the UN Assembly or other purposes. It was noted that networks like this likely exist in other cities.
6. How could this event have disrupted cell service in New York City? Describe possible technical and social impacts.
 - a. This network could have been used to launch denial-of-service attacks which could overwhelm emergency services as mentioned, or create a distraction for something larger.
7. How does this event show the overlap between infrastructure security and cybersecurity?
 - a. Physical infrastructure such as servers in buildings and cybersecurity have overlap shown in this example. As shown, physical infrastructure can be

used for cyberattacks showing how much work is left in the cybersecurity space.

8. How might defenders (engineers, law enforcement, policymakers) prevent or respond to similar threats?
 - a. All of these groups play a role in preventing close-calls like this.
Policymakers can require ID's to be linked to registered sim cards, or require them at the time of activation. Engineers can implement machine learning based algorithms (such as anomaly detection algorithms) to detect clusters of cellphones and find these farms.
9. What lessons can be drawn for telecommunications security, policy, and public communication?
 - a. I believe it can be drawn that there can be a lot drawn from this event.
However, I think there needs to be more communication across carriers and law enforcement so that preventative measures can be put in place.
10. Reflect: How does this case connect to emerging technologies like quantum cryptography or AI-assisted threat detection?
 - a. As mentioned, several machine-learning (AI) algorithms can be used to detect anomalies in telecommunication traffic and SIM farms to percent events like these before they occur.